Reading Comprehension: Fiction & Poetry

Year 4 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Literal Retrieval & Vocabulary

1. The cold glass of the attic window.

2. A) It moved in quick, light, unsteady flaps

3. Thick dust.

4. A wave.

5. His grandson.

6. A) It tipped or jolted suddenly and unsteadily

7. Stallholders shouting prices and a fiddler playing a jig (also acceptable: a dog barking).

8. A) It was full of busy, lively activity and noise

9. A, B and C (the fiddler, the dog, and the smell of chestnuts are all mentioned; rain and a church bell are not).

10. It made the golden heads of wheat bow (bend down).

11. They scattered from the speaker's feet.

12. A) A soft, quiet, hushed sound

13. Her homework diary.

14. The bell rang.

15. She worried that she might have forgotten something important for school.

Inference, Mood & Character

16. He was impatient, annoyed or anxious about being late.

17. A) He is quietly frustrated or irritated

18. He kept his coat on and checked his watch repeatedly.

19. He is frightened or nervous, even though he tries to reassure himself.

20. A) Tense and unsettling

21. That it was just the floorboards settling.

22. She is angry and frustrated, and feels a sense of injustice.

23. A, B and C (she is calm/quiet (D) and someone arguing back (E) are not supported).

24. To show how strongly Jess feels, even without an audience, emphasising the depth of her frustration.

25. The speaker feels lonely or isolated.

26. A) Lonely and reflective

27. The gulls.

28. She is calm, patient, and forgiving — not easily angered.

29. 'Well, now we know it was never glued very well, don't we?'

30. She is trying to make light of the accident and reassure Tom, rather than blame him.

Figurative Language & Devices

31. 'like a rusty gate' — compares the dog's stiff, creaking movement to a rusty gate that doesn't open smoothly.

32. B) personification — the wind is given violent, human-like actions.

33. 'like water in a kettle' — suggests her anger builds up slowly and quietly before suddenly erupting.

34. The house is described as 'tired' and 'groaning', as if it were a living, weary being.

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35. A and B (the clock is personified as 'marching', and the short, steady lines create a rhythmic beat; there is figurative language, and no simile comparing it to a soldier is used).
36. 'like they were on fire' — compares the burning feeling in his legs to being on fire, showing how much effort he was putting in.
37. 'like a sack of stones' — compares the heavy weight of grief to carrying a sack of stones, showing how burdened she feels.
38. A — personification; it gives the city a human trait (sleeping) to show how constantly lively and busy it is.
39. 'like gnarled old hands' — compares the twisted branches to old, wrinkled hands.
40. A) It felt heavy, thick and almost suffocating.
41. The waves are personified as 'clawing' at the cliff, as if they were an animal attacking it; this emphasises how powerful and persistent the erosion seems.
42. A and B (the tree is personified as sheltering travellers, and 'a hundred summers' shows it is very old).
43. 'Her voice was music' — a metaphor suggesting her voice sounded as pleasant and enjoyable to him as music.
44. It suggests the wind made a soft, quiet, gentle sound.
45. Personification — time is given the human ability to 'creep', emphasising how slowly it seemed to pass.

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Literal Retrieval & Vocabulary

1. Scuttling sideways into a hole.
2. Waist-deep in the sea, further out.
3. A) Quick, scurrying, sideways movement
4. Cinnamon and burnt toast.
5. Humming an old tune (while baking/cooking).
6. A) It lightly covered her apron in a thin white layer
7. Whose turn it was on the swing.
8. Building a tower of pebbles in the sandpit.
9. A, B and D (a dog running past and rain falling are not mentioned).
10. It blinks its light across the sea, acting as a steady guide/friend to ships.
11. A restless, rolling sea.
12. A) The sea is constantly moving and never still
13. He tapped the whiteboard twice.
14. 'Books away.'
15. A) An unusual change from the normal lesson routine

Inference, Mood & Character

16. He is nervous or anxious about the exam.
17. A) His leg bouncing under the desk
18. He is anxious about time running out / wishes he had more time.
19. He has mixed feelings — he is happy on the surface but may also feel a little sad, left out or uncertain underneath.
20. A) He hides some of his true feelings in front of others
21. He has become quieter than usual.
22. She is frightened or anxious about thunderstorms.
23. A, B and D (she does not enjoy thunderstorms, and she is not described as alone).
24. She pulls her blanket tighter and counts slowly to ten.
25. The speaker is hopeful and optimistic, trusting that better times (spring) will come.
26. A) Hopeful
27. Winter is currently described; the speaker is confident that spring will follow.
28. She is calm, encouraging, and focuses on positives rather than blame.
29. 'What's one thing we did well today?'
30. A) The players felt able to engage positively despite the loss

Standard / Advanced

31. Oxymoron/personification — pairing 'silence' with 'screamed' (opposites) suggests the quiet felt so intense it was almost unbearable.
32. It suggests his voice sounded harsh and rough, perhaps belonging to an older or weathered person.
33. A) personification — the leaves are given the human action of dancing.
34. It suggests his pride protects him from being hurt, like a shield or suit of armour.
35. It combines the gentle movement of the wind through the grass with the human action of combing, as if the wind were tenderly running fingers through hair.

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36. 'lit up like a boy's' — compares his excited expression to that of a young boy, showing his lasting enthusiasm for the sea.
37. A) He is an experienced man who still has a youthful passion for the sea.
38. Personification: 'The city never slept'. Simile: traffic compared to 'an endless river of light'.
39. A and B (the city is personified, and the traffic is compared to a river using a simile; the extract does contain figurative language, and the buildings are not described as roaring).
40. It suggests grief does not disappear, and its weight varies from day to day, but some sadness always remains.
41. Simile: 'like gnarled old hands'. It creates the impression of an ancient, almost human, protective presence over the lane.
42. A) The leaves' warm colour and the fading of summer.
43. Personification/metaphor — the rivers are described as 'drowning', emphasising how overwhelmed they are by the amount of litter.
44. A, B and D (it does not prove the cliff has collapsed).
45. 'fragile as a candle flame in the wind' — suggests her hope was delicate and could easily be extinguished or lost.

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